

Using the PRC-to-Overlay Tool

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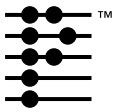
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What This Guide Contains

The following topics are covered in this guide:

- "Introduction" to the prc-to-overlay tool
- "How PRC2OVL Operates"
  - "How the Command-Line Tool Works"
  - "Choosing a Locale"
  - "Modifying the Filter Set"
- PRC2OVL Options
- Getting Help
- "Using PRC2OVL on the Macintosh"

Introduction

The prc-to-overlay (PRC2OVL) tool allows you to produce an overlay database (resource database) that can be superimposed on top of another so that any requests for the underlying "base" database first go through the overlay database. This allows localization to be performed by placing the localized (for example, German) data in an overlay for a particular locale (for example, Germany). You can edit and distribute the overlay separately from the underlying database. Because the overlay only needs to contain localized data, it does not need to include your application code or other large resources.

Example

This example shows the files that are included as part of an application that needs be localized.

The NewApp`.prc` file contains the application named NewApp which is written in English. The `.prc` file contains the following resources:

- `Resource 0: 'CODE' 0`, application code
- `Resource 1: 'CODE' 1`, more application code
- `Resource 2: 'tFRM' 1000`, application form
- `Resource 3: 'tSTR' 1000`, UI strings

When you create a German overlay, a file similar to the following is created for the application:

`NewApp_deDE.prc`

Where:
de indicates the language, German
DE indicates the country, Germany

The file contains the following resources:

- `Resource 0: 'tFRM' 1000`, application form
- `Resource 1: 'tSTR' 1000`, UI strings

How PRC2OVL Operates

The PRC2OVL tool takes a normal resource database (usually an application) as input and produces an overlay. You can also give the tool an overlay as input to create a new overlay for a different locale.

How the Command-Line Tool Works

The command-line tool takes a single file as input, passes the file through a set of filters to decide which particular resources (components of the database) are localizable and should be put in the overlay. Then, given a particular locale, the tool generates an overlay file. See Choosing a Locale for an example of the syntax that you use. Refer to "PRC2OVL Options" on page 4 for a list of the available command-line options.

Choosing a Locale

Use the `-showlocales` option to list the available language and country locale codes. To choose a locale, enter a four-letter locale code:

- The first two letters indicate the language and must be lower case
- The second two letters indicate the country and must be upper case

The following example creates the English overlay and shows how the codes are used:

```
PRC2OVL NewApp.prc -locale enUS -o NewApp_enUS.prc
```

The default resource filters are applied in this example. The -o switch specifies the name of the output file.

Modifying the Filter Set

To add to the filter set, you can use the `-a`, `-n`, `-i`, and `-e` switches.

Where:

`-a` indicates that all resources are to be localized

`-n` indicates that no resources are to be localized

`-i` includes a particular set of resources (in the list of localized resources)

`-e` excludes a particular set.

Each switch operates in the order in which it appears on the command line. The last switch that matches is the one that is operated on, for example:

`'-n -i tFRM 1000'` produces an overlay that only contains the single `'tFRM' 1000` resource (if it is present in the input), but:

`-a -e tFRM 1000'` localizes everything but that one resource.

You can recreate the default filters with the following set of parameters:

```
PRC2OVL -a -e CODE -e DATA -e code -e data -e boot -e extn -e pref
```

You can also restrict matches by ID number. For example, if you only want to localize resource type `'BAZZ'` with ID 567, you say:

```
PRC2OVL -i BAZZ 567
```

You can also supply ranges as shown in the following example:

```
PRC2OVL -i BAZZ 567-599
```

Use the `-v` (for verbose) switch to see what resources are selected in the output.

PRC2OVL Options

Table 1 lists the available options for PRC2OVL command line tool.

Table 1 PRC2OVL Options

Option	Description
`-h`	help
`-o` *filename*	name of output file
`-showlocales`	list available language and locale codes
`-locale` *llCC*	specify a locale code
`-a`	localize all resources
`-n`	localize no resources
`-i` *number*	include a particular set of resources
`-e` *number*	exclude a particular set of resources
`-v`	prints status to screen

Getting Help

You can get help when you:

- Run PRC2OVL (or MPWPRC2OVL) without arguments
- Enter invalid arguments
- Use `-h` on the command line.

Help lists the default resource selection filters.

Using PRC2OVL on the Macintosh

This section describes how to use PRC2OVL on a Macintosh graphical user interface (GUI).

Opening a PRC file

You can use the Mac GUI to create an overlay for a `.prc` file; typically the `.prc` file contains an application or a preference panel. Open the `.prc` file, then pick a target locale (which is the same as the -locale switch). The application displays the entire list of resources in the file, using the same default selection criteria, if necessary, to provide a suggested set of resources to localize. You can edit these by clicking on the checkbox by each item in the list. Then you can build an output file by clicking on the Build button.

Selecting Resources

The Mac GUI tool allows you to select the resources you want to localize from a list rather than specifying resources with filters on the command line. By default, the tool assumes that all resources are overlaid except those of types `'CODE'`, `'DATA'`, `'code'`, `'data'`, `'boot'`, `'extn'`, and `'pref'`. (You can select other resources via the filter options you use in the command-line tool.)